GRADE 7 · MARKETING PACK

How We Talk About This Year

Elevator pitch, parent + teacher one-pagers, social copy, taglines.

Year theme: Know Your Customer

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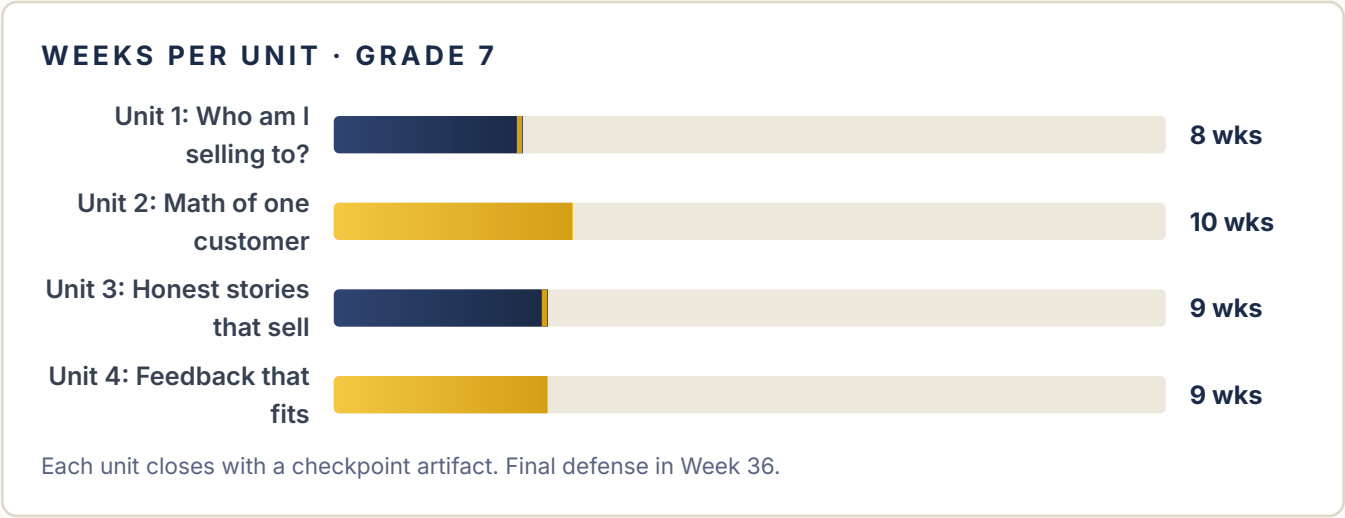
YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.



36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 7 · MARKETING PACK

How We Talk About This Year

Customers are evidence, not assumptions.

Year theme: Know your customer **Band:** 6-8 (canonical pattern grade) · **Audience:** 7th-grader · parent · teacher · admin

3-line elevator pitch

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH

"Cash to Company seventh grade is the program's gold standard: your 12-year-old learns how to find a real customer with real evidence, do the per-customer math, and write honest messaging. Featuring the Customer-First Venture (Capstone) and the line that's becoming a brand: 'revenue is loud. contribution margin is true.' Year 8 of a continuous K-12 mascot arc — mascot-led, no hustle, evidence-based."

Parent-facing one-pager

"Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal."

— CASH

What seventh grade covers

- **Customers are evidence, not assumptions** — interview before you build.
- **Per-customer math** — contribution margin per customer.
- **Honest stories that sell** — the 4-point Fair-to-Customer Check.
- **Feedback as a system** — channel · cadence · triage.
- **Personas vs. demographics** — behavior beats category.
- **A/B test biases** — what your test cannot tell you.
- **Quiet signals** — listening for safety.
- **Customer-First Venture** — the year's Capstone.

Dinner-table earworms

- "Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true."

- "Being wrong is the deal."
- "Honest claims build customers who come back. Tricks build customers who feel taken."

Promise: never asks family money. Never promises wealth. The Capstone is hypothetical (or carefully real); the parent doesn't need to fund anything.

What to say when...

Kid says	You can say
"Want to do my customer interview?"	"Yes — give me the honest answers, including the boring parts."
"How much do you make?"	"That's a grown-up question. What questions does Cash say to ask instead?"
"I want to start the business for real."	"That's a family conversation, separate from the curriculum. Let's talk."

Teacher-facing one-pager

"Tell me what they actually said."

— CASH

Year in 5 sentences

G7 is the **6-8 band anchor** and the program's canonical pattern. Across 36 weeks, students design a Customer-First Venture (Capstone), run real customer interviews, compute contribution margin, write a Capstone Pledge, run a 3-day A/B mini-test, build a 1-week feedback system, and present the Capstone defense. Eight Cash videos drive Mondays. Sensitivity policy enforced; "no money questions in interviews" is a literal rule.

Standards

- CCSS-Math.7.RP, 7.NS, 7.SP (rates, statistics, sampling)
- CCSS-ELA.SL.7.1/.4, W.7.1/.4 (arguments, presenting)
- C3.D2.Eco.6-8.1, .2, .3, .4
- Jump$tart 6-8 (financial literacy benchmarks)
- CASEL: all five competencies

Weekly rhythm

Monday Cash + Q · Wed work block 45-60 min · Friday share-out 15-20 min.

The 8 Cash-video CTAs

1. **V1 (W1)** Day 1 Customer Assumption — one sentence, into the box.
2. **V2 (W9)** Compute contribution margin per customer.
3. **V3 (W19)** Capstone Pledge — 3 sentences.
4. **V4 (W29)** Three-question survey design.
5. **V5 (W3)** Persona v1 — count B vs. D entries.
6. **V6 (W27)** Two sentences after your A/B test.
7. **V7 (W33)** Mark the quietest comment in your survey.
8. **V8 (W36)** Capstone Defense.

What to say when...

- "This is dumb. I'm never starting a business." — "You don't have to. You're learning to be a clearer thinker about money — that works for any job."
- "My family doesn't have money for this." — "This is a hypothetical Capstone. Real-life money is a separate conversation."
- "Why can't I ask 'how much would you spend'?" — "What did Cash say? Money comes later. Listen for what frustrates them first."

Admin pitch outline

"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true."

— CASH

1. **Outcomes:** every G7 student designs a Customer-First Venture, runs ≥3 customer interviews, computes contribution margin, applies a 4-point ad ethics check, runs an A/B test with bias analysis, builds a feedback system.
2. **Standards alignment:** CCSS-Math.7.RP/NS/SP, ELA.SL.7.1/4, W.7.1/4, C3.D2.Eco.6-8.1-4, Jump$tart 6-8, CASEL all 5.
3. **Equity:** sensitivity policy explicitly forbids family-money probes; "no money in customer interviews" rule; printable; gender/race-neutral mascot; equity-by-design.
4. **Evidence:** Fall 2026 pilot pre/post Jump$tart middle-school assessment + qualitative student & teacher interviews.

5. **Differentiator:** NGPF is HS-only; we cover middle school as part of the K-12 arc. JA Career Connections is volunteer-coordinated and event-shaped; we are routine-shaped (Monday opener every week). EVERFI is sponsor-funded; we have no sponsor.

Hashtag bank (25)

`#CashToCompany` `#LearnWithCash` `#CashSays` `#WhichPeopleAndHowDoYouKnow` `#MostAdultsSkipThis` `#SeventhGrade` `#7thGrade` `#7thGradeTeacher` `#MiddleSchool` `#MiddleSchoolTeacher` `#TeachersOfInstagram` `#TeacherTok` `#FinLitTeacher` `#FinancialLiteracy` `#EntrepreneurshipForKids` `#ContributionMargin` `#KnowYourCustomer` `#CustomerInterview` `#CapstonePledge` `#ParentingTok` `#NoHustleParenting` `#CTEteacher` `#MS-Curriculum` `#BeingWrongIsTheDeal` `#RevenueLoudCMtrue`

Sample social posts

Kid-direct

1. "My 12-year-old just held up a comp napkin diagram of two lemonade stands and explained why Stand B (lower revenue) actually wins. Cash to Company V2 is THE viral moment." + V2 Short. **(THIS POST WILL CARRY THE BRAND.)**
2. "Capstone Pledge from my 7th grader: 'In my Capstone, I will not exaggerate. I will name my real evidence. If a friend told me to stretch the truth, I would say no.' (Caption: who raised her? Cash, apparently.)"
3. "Customer interview tip from my 12-year-old: 'don't ask how much they'd pay. Ask what frustrates them.' Bro that's a sales course." + V1 Short.

Parent-direct

1. "'Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true.' My middle-schooler said this at the dinner table tonight. Cash to Company is rewriting financial-literacy curriculum — K through 12, one continuous mascot." + V2 Short.
2. "Cash to Company won't let my kid ask people 'how much would you pay' in a customer interview. Why? Because that's not where the evidence is. (K-12 curriculum. One mascot. Mascot is a coin.)"
3. "The line that's making me a Cash to Company evangelist: 'being wrong is the deal.' I want this on a t-shirt."

Teacher-direct

1. "V2 — Two lemonade stands → contribution margin twist → my 7th grade got QUIET. Best Monday opener of my year. K-12 mascot continuity." + V2 Short.

2. "Cash V5 — 'Same demographics. Different customers.' — my class is now using behavioral-persona language unprompted. The card-flip reveal is so good." + V5 Short.
3. "The Capstone Pledge — 3 sentences, kids sign it, tape it inside the journal. Best $0 commitment device I've taught. Cash to Company V3."

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

> *"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."*
>
> — CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 7 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 7 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist.
The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-2	Identify ways consumers may avoid making poor decisions; apply to entrepreneurs avoiding poor customer guesses.
CCSS-ELA W.7.4	Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task.
CCSS-ELA SL.7.1	Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions.
CASEL Social Awareness	Recognize the perspectives of others; demonstrate empathy.
C3 D2.Eco.1.6-8	Explain how economic decisions affect well-being of individuals, businesses, society.
Jump$tart 1 (Spending & Saving) 8-2	Demonstrate ability to use number skills to manage money.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."

— CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Per-Customer Math at the Snack Stand

Devon sells protein cookies after school. He sells 30 cookies a week at $2.00 each. Revenue is $60. He spends $0.85 on each cookie (oats, peanut butter, packaging). His variable cost per cookie is $0.85.

Contribution margin per cookie = $2.00 - $0.85 = **$1.15**. His fixed cost (the table he rents from the school store) is $20/week. He needs **$20 / $1.15 = 18 cookies/week** just to cover the table. He's currently selling 30. He's clearing $14.50/week after fixed costs.

Devon's question to Cash: should he raise the price to $2.50? Cash answers with a question: "Which people, and how do you know? Run a 3-day test. Half the kids see $2.00. Half see $2.50. Tell me what they actually buy."

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

> *"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."*
>
> — CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"Customers are evidence, not assumptions."

— CASH, GRADE 7